



USSR Premier Nikita Khrushchev and US President John F. Kennedy

Nations Charter will apply. Why, therefore, should man's first flight to the moon be a matter of national competition? Why should the United States and the Soviet Union, in preparing for such expeditions, become involved in immense duplications of research, construction, and expenditure? Surely we should explore whether the scientists and astronauts of our two countries – indeed of all the world – cannot work together in the conquest of space, sending someday in this decade to the moon not the representatives of a single nation, but the representatives of all of our countries.”

The proposal was met with applause in the Assembly, but Khrushchev was quick to dismiss it. However, his son later recounted that the Soviet Premier was considering it in late 1963, when Kennedy was assassinated.

Khrushchev did not enjoy the same rapport or trust with Kennedy's successor, President Lyndon Johnson, and abandoned the plans.

Another Upheaval

In 1964, there was another shake-up in the Soviet political scenario and Khrushchev was removed from power. The repercussions of this were felt strongly in the Soviet Space Programme as Chelomei was finally told to cede his moon programme to Korolev, who was once again put in charge of all projects in the SSP. And there was a new objective of getting to Earth's natural satellite by 1967 – the 50th anniversary of the Communist Revolution.